

You said it...

correct this (it works in 9.04).

12. The PC gets stuck if the 'Style' is changed under 'Change Desktop Background'.
13. Is generally slower than U904.
14. OOo 3.1, which is normally faster than 3.0, suddenly becomes slower, with the display lagging two to four keystrokes behind.

Use of OSS to break the rules

I am not exactly a techie, but I know a bit about OSS since I've been using it for the last four years. I want to share a story that brings joy to me and demonstrates the power of the open source community. In July, I planned to purchase a UPS for my system due to power problems in my locality—I needed it because my 'unmanned' Linux box works as a HTTP server. I wanted a solution such that, if the mains power went off, then it needed to invoke an automated power shut down (in case the battery also went down after a specified period).

So I went to a shop and specified my requirements. I was recommended WEP 690 VA super model. However, those at the store weren't aware of any Linux support. I searched for Linux drivers, and even mailed WEP to enquire. They replied that the model doesn't support automated shut down in case of power failure (my requirement), and that they'd replace the product, free of cost.

But I did not lose patience. I simply downloaded the RPM of powerd (powerd-2.0.0-1) and configured that. To my surprise, it worked! I sent a mail to the support person who admitted that he wasn't aware of this—he being a WEP employee himself!

Well, that's the power of open source—hats off to it!

—Diptanu Paul, diptanu@yahoo.com

ED: And people still think GNU/Linux is lagging behind :-)

Errata December 2009

- The boot splash screen after installing openSUSE 11.2 from the LFD dual-layer DVD doesn't work. To fix it, run the following as root:
`cd /boot/ && mkinitrd`
- The cover price of the issue was Rs 110/- . However, it was printed as Rs 100/- above the bar code. We regret the inconvenience.

Please send your comments or suggestions to:

The Editor

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